



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 5338

LCO No. 1919



Referred to Committee on ENERGY AND TECHNOLOGY

Introduced by:
(ET)

AN ACT CONCERNING THE DESIGNATION OF CERTAIN SERVICE PROVIDERS FOR PURPOSES OF THE FEDERAL LIFELINE SERVICE BENEFITS.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsection (a) of section 16-247e of the general statutes is
2 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
3 *1, 2026*):

4 (a) [In order to] To ensure the universal availability of affordable,
5 high quality telecommunications services to all residents and businesses
6 throughout the state regardless of income, disability or location, the
7 authority shall (1) periodically investigate and determine, after notice
8 and hearing, local service options, including the definition and
9 components of any basic telecommunications services, necessary to
10 achieve universal service and meet customer needs; and (2) establish
11 lifeline and telecommunications relay service programs funded by all
12 telecommunications [carriers] service providers that provide intrastate
13 telecommunications services, as such terms are defined in 47 USC 153,
14 as amended from time to time, sufficient to provide low-income

15 households or individuals, or persons who are hard of hearing or speech
 16 impaired, with a level of telecommunications service or package of
 17 telecommunications services that supports participation in the economy
 18 and society of the state. The authority shall apportion the funding for
 19 the lifeline and telecommunications relay service programs among
 20 telecommunications [carriers] service providers on an equitable basis
 21 based on the gross revenues of each telecommunications [carrier]
 22 service provider that are generated in [Connecticut] the state, [both]
 23 whether based on interstate [and] or intrastate services. The lifeline and
 24 telecommunications relay service programs shall be administered by an
 25 entity authorized, and subject to oversight, by the authority. The
 26 authority shall determine by order any telecommunications service
 27 provider eligible to provide benefits pursuant to the lifeline program
 28 and which customers qualify for [the lifeline] benefits pursuant to such
 29 program. Recipients of lifeline funds shall use such funds to pay for
 30 telecommunications services provided by [any] a telecommunications
 31 [carrier] service provider.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	16-247e(a)
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Statement of Purpose:

To authorize the Public Utilities Regulatory Authority to determine which telecommunications service providers are eligible to provide benefits pursuant to the federal lifeline program.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]